

THE HARAPPAN CIVILIZATION

CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER FLOWCHART | CORE FIRST, INFERENCE BOUNDED

REGIONALISATION -> INTEGRATION -> LOCALISATION / DEURBANISATION

01

NAME, PHASES, METHOD

EARLY
c. 3300-2600 BCE
regionalisation

MATURE
c. 2600-1900 BCE
integration

LATE
c. 1900-1300 BCE
localisation

PHASES ARE PROCESSES

DATES VARY REGIONALLY

02

DISCOVERY AND HISTORIOGRAPHY

Cunningham noticed a seal; Sahni excavated Harappa in 1921; Banerji worked at Mohenjo-daro; Marshall announced the civilisation. Research moved from monuments/invasion to households, landscapes and science.

CONTEXT BEFORE LABEL

NO NATIVE CHRONICLE

03

MAP AND ECOLOGICAL DOMAINS

MANDA

SUTKAGEN-DOR

CORE

MALVAN

ALAMGIRPUR

MULTI-ECOLOGICAL

SARASVATI IDENTIFICATION SEPARATE

04

SETTLEMENT HIERARCHY AND LABOUR

CITIES

TOWNS / SPECIALISTS

VILLAGES

FARMS / HERDS / RESOURCES

URBAN-RURAL SYSTEM

FUNCTION != LEGAL STATUS

05

SITE-FEATURE PRECISION

Harappa: R-37/working platforms. Mohenjo-daro: Great Bath/wells. Dholavira: reservoirs/signboard. Kalibangan: plough marks. Lothal: basin/craft. Banawali: moat/plough model.

PAIR + PLACE + CAUTION

NO FEATURE SWAPS

06

REGIONAL SITE CORRECTIONS

Rakhigarhi: major Haryana complex and sample-bounded DNA. Chanhudaro: unfortified craft town. Surkotada: fortified site with disputed equid. Shortugai: procurement outpost, not automatic province.

ONE GENOME != CIVILISATION

HORSE CLAIM DISPUTED

07

PLANNING, WATER AND MAINTENANCE

SOURCE

HOUSEHOLD

DRAIN

STORAGE / OUTFLOW

MAINTENANCE

COORDINATION SECURE

GOVERNING OFFICE UNKNOWN

08

SUBSISTENCE AND CRAFT

Wheat/barley plus regional millets/rice, pulses/oilseeds, cotton and herds. Beads, shell, faience, pottery, textiles and copper/bronze reveal skilled production; iron is not characteristic.

DIVERSE FOOD BASE

BRONZE NOT IRON

09

MEASUREMENT AND TRADE

Graded weights, scales, seals and transport integrated internal exchange.

Meluhha, Dilmun and Magan connect the Harappan world to Gulf-Mesopotamian circuits.

WEIGHTS NOT COINS

CONTACT != COLONY

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SCRIPT, POLITY AND SOCIETY

Short patterned inscriptions can be analysed but not translated.. Standardisation supports strong coordination; central state, regional states and corporate elites remain alternatives.

Houses/burials show difference, not caste.

NO KING-LIST

INFERENCE LADDER

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RELIGION, DECLINE AND CONTINUITY

Horned figure, female figurines, fire features and baths permit ritual hypotheses only. River/climate, trade and reorganisation interacted after c. 1900 BCE; Late communities continued.

NO NAMED CREED

TRANSFORMATION NOT EXTINCTION

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SCIENCE, PYQS AND ANSWER SPINE

Method -> sample/context -> result -> scale limit. PYQs: Sohgauro, Dholavira, bronze Dancing Girl, household inference and architecture. Answer: define -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

SCIENCE NARROWS CLAIMS

COORDINATED DIVERSITY

ANSWER SPINE: CLAIM -> NAMED EVIDENCE -> ANALYSIS -> QUALIFICATION -> VERDICT